

UPSC

Candidate must adhere to the word limit specified in the question.
Any page or portion of the page left blank must be clearly struck off.

Q- How does the spirit of the Preamble confront the realities of caste, poverty, patriarchy, and majoritarianism in contemporary India?

Ans. The Preamble of the Indian Constitution enshrines values like justice, liberty, equality, fraternity, socialist, secular etc. These principles challenge the persistent social evils - caste, poverty, patriarchy and majoritarianism. It also aligns with Rawls's idea of justice as fairness and Gandhi's Sarvodaya both of which emphasize uplifting the weakest section of society.

These ideals confront the realities as follows —

UPSC

Candidate must adhere to the word limit specified in the question.
Any page or portion of the page left blank must be clearly struck off.

① Caste Discrimination —

↳ The Preamble's ideals of justice and equality of status challenges the rigid stratification of society.

↳ Dr B.R. Ambedkar described caste as marked by segmental division, social exclusion, hierarchy, endogamy etc. These features made caste a powerful instrument of inequality.

↳ The constitution confronts this by promoting equality through affirmative action.

↳ e.g., reservation under Art 15(4) and 16(4), SC/ST Prevention of Atrocities Act, 1989

② Poverty —

↳ The Preamble's ideals of social and economic justice confronts poverty and promotes a welfare state.

UPSC

Candidate must adhere to the word limit specified in the question.
Any page or portion of the page left blank must be clearly struck off.

↳ Gandhiji also said, "poverty is the worst form of violence" and these ideals also reflect his vision of Sarvodaya.

E.g. MGNREGA → legal guarantee to rural employment

~~NA~~ NFSA, 2013 → subsidized food grains to poor people.

③ Patriarchy —

↳ The ideals of justice, liberty, equality challenges patriarchal norms and promotes women empowerment.

↳ The provision of equality of opportunity empowers women to participate in all spheres of life.

E.g. Reservation for women in Panchayats
Nari Vardhan Adhiniyam, 2023
Beti Bachao Beti Padhao

Candidate must adhere to the word limit specified in the question.
Any page or portion of the page left blank must be clearly struck off.

④ Majoritarianism —

↳ The ideals of fraternity, equality, secularism confront dominance of majority and advocates for peace, harmony, social cohesion and protection of minority rights.

↳ The Preamble envisions a multicultural nation where diverse communities coexist promoting unity in diversity.

↳ Protection of minority rights
(Art 29 & 30)

• Secularism as basic feature and right to freedom of religion under Art (25-28)

Limitations —

<u>Issue</u>	<u>Limitations</u>	<u>Impact</u>
① Caste	Social prejudice and caste based exclusion	Undermines social justice and equality.

इस हाशिप
में केवल
प्रश्न संख्या
लिखें।

Specimen Booklet

Only write
question
number in
this margin

UPSC

For Practice Purpose Only

उम्मीदवारों को
इस हाशिप में
नहीं लिखना
चाहिए।

Candidates
must not
write on
this margin.

Candidate must adhere to the word limit specified in the question.
Any page or portion of the page left blank must be clearly struck off.

<u>Issue</u>	<u>Limitations</u>	<u>Impact</u>
② Poverty	Social mobility Exclusion in welfare delivery programmes, informalization of labour	Social mobility is affected, perpetuates inequality
③ Patriarchy	Deep rooted cultural norms, <u>token</u> <u>representation</u> of women	Limits their agency and economic and social growth
④ Majoritarianism	Communal polarisation, Vote-bank politics	Weakens fraternity, secularism and social cohesion

UPSC

Candidate must adhere to the word limit specified in the question.
Any page or portion of the page left blank must be clearly struck off.

Way forward -

- ① Promote constitutional literacy through school curriculum and campaigns as done by Kollam, Kerala
- ② Fast track courts for social justice related cases
- ③ Promote interfaith and inter-caste dialogue to ~~pro~~ ensure fraternity

The Preamble gives us the vision of equal and just India. As Amartya Sen says development is about giving people choice and freedom. To achieve this we should ensure that the ideals of Preamble are practiced in everyday governance.